Russell Jalal

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student at the University at Albany (graduating May 2027) and CompTIA Security+ certified, currently working as a Lead Pharmacy Technician while funding my education full time. I reinforce my coursework through a personal website documenting my learning and home lab projects, plus YouTube tutorials on how ticketing and helpdesk systems work. I'm also an independent songwriter with original music on all major streaming platforms; a creative foundation which I believe is much needed in this day and age of AI.

EDUCATION

- **University at Albany** **May 2027**
  Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity
  Dean's List | GPA: 4.0
- **Suffolk County Community College, Selden, NY** **May 2025**
  Cybersecurity & Information Assurance | A.A.S
  Highest Distinction | Dean's List | GPA: 4.0

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Pharmacy Technician **May 2020 – Present**
CVS Pharmacy, Westhampton Beach

- Lead a team of up to 6 technicians per shift in a high-volume pharmacy filling roughly 600 prescriptions daily, coordinating staff, workflow, and service delivery.
- Proactively manage workflow and inventory to exceed company performance metrics, sustaining top-performing status within a 23-pharmacy district.
- Hire, train, and mentor technicians, and troubleshoot and escalate technology issues to IT support.

Information Technology Technician | Student Assistant
Mastics Moriches Shirley Community Library ***June 2026-August 2026***

- Supported IT operations for a library environment of roughly 80 computers, assisting the IT department with workstation setup, cabling, and ongoing maintenance.
- Assisted with administration of Cisco Meraki firewalls, Alcatel-Lucent switches, VLANs, and network security, plus Active Directory deployment and Hyper-V on Dell PowerEdge servers.
- Provided front-line IT support to staff, resolving their technical issues, and helped maintain Avaya Cloud Office phones, EnvisionWare, RFID security, and Deep Freeze on public computers.

TECHNOLOGY PROJECTS

Cybersecurity Capstone **May 2025**

- Configured a Cisco Layer 3 switch to perform inter-VLAN routing and Dynamic routing using OSPF while implementing trunking, DHCP relay, port security, and ACL-based traffic control.
- Deployed Windows Server with Active Directory, DNS, DHCP (with Linux Clients) and Network Policy Server providing RADIUS authentication.

pfSense Firewall & DoS Simulation **July 2025**

- Executed Kali-based denial-of-service attack against Ubuntu target in controlled environment.
- Implemented WAN/LAN separation, firewall rules and static routing to contain malicious traffic.

Enterprise Linux Active Directory System **August 2025**

- Linux system integration with Windows Active Directory, routed traffic through pfSense perimeter firewall.
- Batch installation of software via group policies.